

IT Ticketing Workflow Updated Document

1. Description of IT ticketing.

This document defines the end-to-end lifecycle of a support ticket, including system behaviour, automation logic, assignment strategies, SLA management, escalation handling, and reporting mechanisms to ensure efficient issue resolution and SLA compliance.

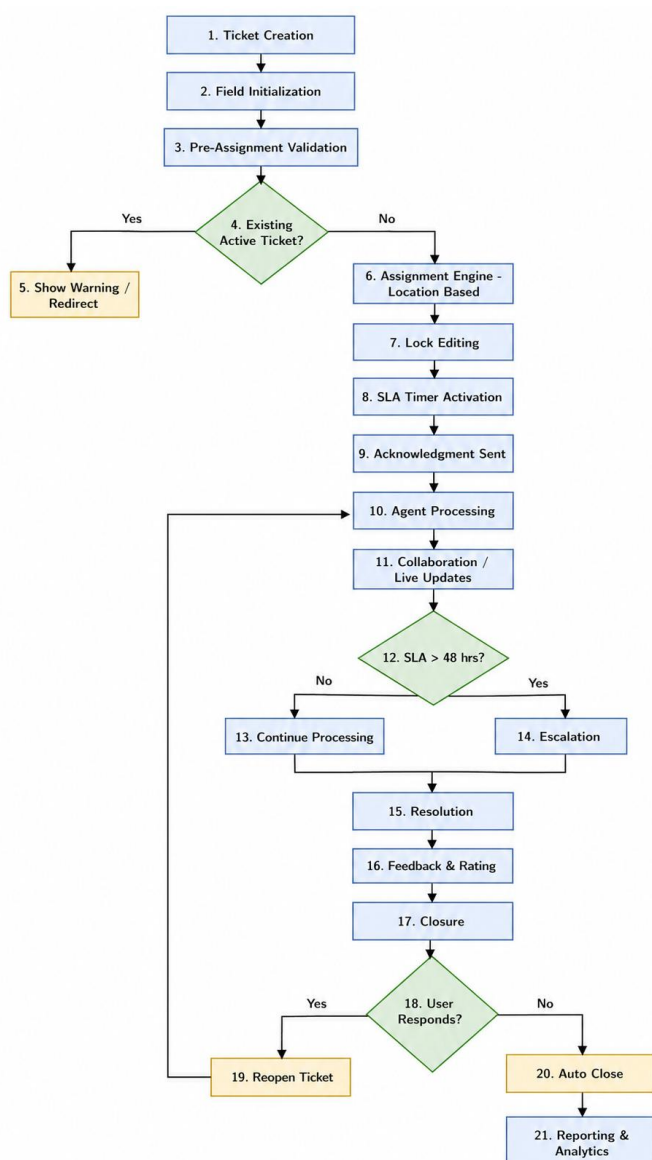
2. Scope

This workflow applies to ticket creation and management through the **web-based user portal**. It enables users to raise, track, and manage support requests within the system.

Additionally, the platform supports **manual ticket creation by IT agents**, where applicable.

The system is designed with a **scalable multi-department architecture**, allowing future integration with additional channels such as email, chat systems, and APIs.

3. Ticket Lifecycle Overview



4. Ticket Creation & User Controls

4.1 Functional Behavior

- Tickets remain **editable in pre-assignment state**
- Post-assignment → **fields become read-only (state lock)**
- System provides **real-time event-driven notifications**

4.2 Ticket Creation Restriction Logic

System validates for existing active tickets:

Pending States Considered:

- Open
- Assigned
- In Progress
- Resolved (pending confirmation)

Control Mechanism:

- **Soft Validation (Recommended Initial Phase)**
- **Optional Hard Restriction Enforcement (Future Phase)**

System Prompt Behaviour:

- Displays:
 - Ticket ID
 - Issue summary
 - Current status
 - Assigned IT engineer
- User options:
 - Navigate to existing ticket
 - Proceed with override (with justification, if enabled)



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5. Assignment Engine (Location-Based Routing Model)

5.1 Location-Based Assignment

- Tickets are routed based on **user location metadata**
- Assignment is mapped to **location-specific IT support groups**

5.2 Shared Visibility & Work Distribution

- All IT engineers have **global ticket visibility**

Enables:

- Self-assignment (**pull-based model**)
- Collaborative ticket handling
- Dynamic workload distribution

5.3 Assignment Logic

- Initial routing to **location-based queue**

Engineers can:

- Pick (**self-assign**) tickets
- Reassign within authorized scope

5.4 Fallback Mechanism

- If no matching condition:
→ Route to **default support queue**

5.5 Assignment Rule 5: Ticket Reassignment (Engineer Availability Handling)

Objective

Ensure uninterrupted ticket handling during engineer unavailability (e.g., leave, workload constraints).



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Reassignment Triggers

- Engineer marked as **Unavailable (Leave Mode)**
- Manual reassignment by engineer
- Admin/Manager override
- SLA risk or breach

Reassignment Process

Manual Reassignment:

- Assigned engineer can transfer ticket to another engineer within the same **location/support group**
- Handover notes can be added

Automatic Reassignment:

- When engineer status = **Unavailable**:
 - System reassigns all active tickets to:
 - Predefined backup engineer OR
 - Next available engineer (based on location, skill, workload)

Admin Override:

- Admin/Manager can reassign tickets at any time

Notifications

- New engineer → receives alert & email
- Previous engineer → notified of reassignment
- User → notified of new assigned engineer

SLA Behaviour

- SLA timer **continues without reset**

Audit Tracking

- Logs:
 - Previous & new assignee



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- Timestamp
- Reassignment reason

Fallback

- If no engineer available:
→ Route to **default or escalation queue**

6. Notification & Communication Framework

6.1 User Notifications

Triggered on:

- Ticket creation
- Assignment (includes assigned engineer details)
- Status transitions
- Closure

6.2 Engineer Notifications

- Broadcast notifications to **all IT engineers**
- Channels:
 - Email
 - System alerts
- Supported platforms:
 - Desktop
 - Laptop

6.3 Communication Capabilities

- Engineers have permission to:
 - Initiate outbound communication
 - Send system-triggered emails/messages to users

7. Category Management

Standardized categories include:

- Laptop Support
- Desktop Support



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- Software Issues
- Network Issues

Supports **dynamic category configuration and extension**.

8. SLA & Escalation Management

8.1 Escalation Policy

- Automatic escalation triggered if:
 - Ticket remains unresolved beyond **48 hours**

8.2 Escalation Actions

- Priority escalation
- Hierarchical notification (Lead / Manager)
- Ticket reassignment

9. Feedback & Rating Mechanism

- **Rating → Mandatory (enforced input)**
- **Feedback → Optional**
- **Comments → Optional**

Triggered post-resolution for service evaluation.

10. Closure & Re-Ticketing Policy

10.1 Closure Behaviour

- Closed tickets transition to **read-only state**
- No further modifications allowed

10.2 Re-Ticketing Rule

- Users must:
 - Reference **previous ticket ID**
 - Create a **new linked ticket**

10.3 Dependency Enforcement

New ticket creation rules:

- For the same existing category / issue type: new ticket can be raised only after the previous related ticket is closed.
- For a different category / different issue type: user can raise a new ticket immediately, even if another ticket is still open.
- System should check open tickets by user + category before allowing creation.
- Previous and new related tickets should maintain traceability through ticket linkage/reference.

Example

- Existing open ticket = Laptop issue
- New Laptop issue ticket → Not allowed until previous laptop ticket is closed.
- New Desktop issue ticket → Allowed immediately.

Purpose

- Prevent duplicate tickets for the same issue
- Allow users to report separate problems without delay
- Maintain proper tracking and history

11. Reopen / Re-Ticketing Workflow (Finalized)

11.1 Workflow Logic

- Users **cannot directly reopen a closed ticket**
- Users must initiate action through **new ticket creation linked to previous ticket**

11.2 Process Flow

1. User creates a **new ticket referencing the previous Ticket ID**
2. System validates the referenced ticket status

11.3 System Decision

If previous ticket is eligible for reopen:

- System converts request into **Reopen Request**
- Status → **Reopen Requested**



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- Ticket is routed to **previous assigned engineer**
- Notification sent to engineer

If reopen is not allowed / rejected:

- New ticket continues as a **separate ticket**
- Link maintained for **traceability**

11.4 Engineer Action

- Engineer reviews the request

If approved:

- Status → **Open**
- Assigned to previous engineer
- SLA → Reset/Resume

If rejected:

- Ticket remains closed
- New ticket handled independently

11.5 Key Behaviour

- Maintains **control (no direct reopen)**
- Avoids **duplicate/misuse**
- Ensures **traceability between old and new tickets**

12. Dashboard & Reporting Framework

12.1 Dashboard

Provides real-time metrics:

- Open tickets
- In-progress tickets
- Closed tickets
- SLA breach indicators

12.2 Reporting

- Weekly reports including:
 - Ticket volume
 - Resolution metrics
 - SLA compliance
 - Escalation trends

13. Real-Time System Capabilities

- Event-driven architecture for:
 - Live updates
 - Instant alerts
 - Activity tracking

14. Key Control Points

- Pre-assignment editability with post-assignment state lock
- Location-based intelligent routing
- Global ticket visibility for IT teams
- Continuous SLA monitoring
- Automated escalation at defined thresholds (48 hrs)
- Duplicate ticket prevention via validation logic
- Mandatory rating enforcement
- Complete audit trail and activity logging

15. Final Note

This workflow is aligned with enterprise-grade ITSM standards and ensures:

- Structured and controlled ticket lifecycle
- Location-aware routing efficiency
- Enhanced collaboration across IT teams
- SLA adherence and escalation governance
- Improved end-user experience and accountability



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